Chapter Twenty-Three

State of Environmental Economy

Low Per-Capita Total Emissions, but Rising

India's total greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions were estimated to be the equivalent of 3.202 million tonnes of carbon dioxide (CO_2) in 2014, which made our per-capita GHG emissions about 2.48 tonnes of CO_2 equivalent per person. The country's share was 6.55 per cent of total global GHG emissions of 48.89 billion tonnes of CO_2 equivalent. India's per-capita emissions were far lower than global emissions of 6.73 tonnes of CO_2 equivalent.

The country's total GHG emissions of 3.202 million tonnes of CO_2 equivalent for a $2.131 trillion economy meant that the energy intensity of India's GDP, measured in tonnes of CO_2 equivalent per million dollars of GDP, was 1503 tonnes of CO_2 equivalent. Global energy intensity was 665 tonnes. In this metric, India's energy intensity was 2.26 times the global average.

CO_2 forms the largest component of GHGs. India reportedly emitted 2.299 million tonnes of CO_2 in 2018, 4.8 per cent more than the previous year.

That said, India made impressive environmental commitments as part of nationally determined contributions. In fact, the global Climate Action Tracker has rated the country's efforts as '2 degree compatible'—this means such efforts could limit average global temperature rise to 2°C by 2100.